

## EMAIL

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## PHONE

2408987286

## LOCATION

Beltsville, Maryland

## CERTIFICATIONS

- Splunk Core Certified User
- Splunk Core Power User
- Splunk Enterprise Administrator
- Professional Scrum Master I

## SKILLS

Cribl | SIEM | Linux RHEL (Red Hat & Ubuntu) | Data Onboarding | Incident Response | Kubernetes | RegEx | SPL | Gitlab/Github | SQL | XML | Python | Bash | AWS | Docker | Agile | Jira | FreshServices | ServiceNow | SuccessFactors Reporting & Management | SAP Query Manager | Enterprise Reporting | Kronos Timekeeper

## EDUCATION

**Bachelor of Science** - Towson University

# Austin Ugbaja

Experienced Security Engineer specializing in Splunk with years of hands-on experience in managing and optimizing large-scale Splunk environments. Stacked with in-depth knowledge of everything from deployment servers and search heads to cluster managers, indexers, and deployers. Proficient in designing user-centered dashboards, developing custom use cases, improving workflow automation, and driving productivity aligned with key business needs. Experienced in administering Splunk Enterprise and Splunk Cloud platforms, with a drive toward system performance improvements and simplification of data processes. Recognized for simplifying complex issues into simple and clear actionable insights and fostering collaboration while being committed to leveraging data intelligence for innovative solutions that drive organizational growth and efficiency.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES & ACCOMPLISHMENTS

**Splunk Administrator**, July 2022 - Current  
*Johns Hopkins University*  
Baltimore, MD

- Lead Splunk Architect responsible for implementing and provisioning new Splunk Architecture (new indexers, deployment server, search heads, and forwarders)
- Developed comprehensive dashboards for Networking teams regarding key metrics regarding IT Operation metrics such as Firewall dashboards which contained Top Firewall Sources and Destinations along with port access information and detailed client-to-server and server-to-client connection insights which enhanced metric visibility.
- Completed project to normalize data in 50+ indexes through CIM configuration utilizing event types, field aliases, and tags mapped to several data models such as Performance, Authentication, Network, Web, and Endpoint
- Established and automated the index creation process which implements standard retention policies across the Splunk environment customizing each index retention to suit business needs.
- Proactively monitor user activity and concurrency within the Splunk environment in order to allow for effective resource allocation.
- Migrated our KV Store from mmap v1 to WiredTiger while partaking in the updating of our Splunk Enterprise network to 9.0.1
- Diagnosed and resolved a critical issue relating to all the content from the KV Store disappearing upon adding new KVs from a deployment server, this was caused by Splunk restarting and safeguards were implemented to prevent client reboots during KV store updates.

- Resolve data distortion issues when forwarding syslog data to Power BI by analyzing Splunk's handling of missing sourcetypes in outputs.conf, optimizing configuration files to ensure accurate data integration and pipeline reliability.
- Successfully created an Ansible script to conduct bulk upgrades of universal forwarders within the environment.
- Onboard numerous data sources using Universal and Heavy Forwarders, HTTP Event Collector (HEC), APIs, and Syslog into Splunk from tools such as but not limited to application logs, network devices, and endpoint devices like Fortinet FortiGate, Citrix logs, Symantec Endpoint Protection, and AWS Flow Logs.
- Successfully implemented SSL encryption for secure communication on Splunk Web ports and internal communication ports between components to help enhance data security and compliance.
- Resolved issues regarding overloaded ingestion pipeline queues which hindered full ingestion of Windows Event Logs into indexers using Heavy Forwarders by conducting multiple troubleshooting techniques which in the end was resolved by making adjustments to inputs.conf and limits.conf
- Maintained and optimized accelerated data models to improve the Security Engineers' access to large-scale SCADA system data and REncigma analytics, allowing for quick and easy access to data for more efficient analysis.
- Troubleshoot numerous issues as they arise relating to data replication, configuration files, dashboards, users, forwarder communication, and many others through usage of many tools within Splunk such as Btool, log files, or through the CLI.
- Decommissioned indexers and search heads to consolidate the environment and improve performance.
- Develop advanced Splunk queries for analysis, including predictive analysis using the predict command and field extractor.
- Modify critical and sensitive information that is attached to data being onboarded as advised under the advisory of the data owners through the use of regex, props.conf, and transforms.conf
- Collaborated with external entities with intentions of streamlining data ingestion and picked up hands-on experience with Cribl stream to help with data parsing techniques.
- Create audit dashboards and reports for various teams, including the Research, Networking team, and C-suite executives.
- Configure event types and other Knowledge Objects within the environment through the use of tailored queries based on incoming data enabling users to access certain information with ease
- Performed daily health checks through custom-built health check dashboards, Monitoring Console, Cluster Manager, and internal logs

#### **Splunk Engineer**, February 2020- May 2022

*Erie Insurance Group*

*Erie, PA*

- Automated the deployment of custom CA SSL certificates to Splunk instances to help monitor traffic relating to Splunkd, ensuring secure communication and compliance with current security standards
- Assembled a vital alert to monitor the Indexers with the environment, triggering real-time email notifications once detected that any reset activity had occurred. This ensures that the team responds promptly to any issue regarding ingestion.
- Automated the creation of Splunk Apps and Server Classes to match company-specific naming conventions enabling precise groupings for forwarders and deployment apps based on geographic location and functionality. This automation resulted in easier maintenance of overall version control within Github.
- Managed the bucket system within the environment and configured retention policies for data storage.
- Collaborated with end users to improve the quality and performance of the dashboards created, improving the visibility and making it more accessible while reducing the amount of resources taken up by adding base searches. Other changes consist of improving the usability of the dashboards by adding more data for drilldowns, utilizing the eval and stats command to aggregate statistics, and adding inputs or advising for certain changes within the dashboard itself.
- Manage and monitor over 35,000 forwarders through the use of multiple deployment servers allowing for efficient data collection and stress-free scalability throughout the Splunk Environment.
- Partition servers within the environment through the use of LVM which includes managing the storage within servers and monitoring logical volume within Linux.
- Conducted advanced data analysis in Splunk at an advanced level with in-depth expertise in Eval functions, advanced use of the stats command (including Tstats, Eventstats, and Streamstats), Lookups, and Subsearches.
- Collaborate with team members to develop macros, field aliases, tags, event types, and lookup tables in order to promote standardization for common complex queries.
- Installed and configured Splunk DB Connect inputs on Heavy Forwarders within the environment to seamlessly connect and integrate with SQL servers managed by another external team.

- Optimized scheduled reports within the environment to ensure consistent execution with minimal skips by altering schedules to run on Cron Schedules in comparison to fixed time periods.
- Built an alert for the networking team which triggers when the CPU utilization for the designated servers are over 90%. This caused a reduced percentage of unexpected downtime.
- Responsible for the management of role-based LDAP access to Splunk instances
- Identified key components within previously built Networking dashboards and implemented new queries and source code that optimized performance for over 25 users.
- Built intermediate forwarders to accommodate for internal policies on data flow between different networks within the infrastructure and monitored forwarder performance and troubleshooted forwarders that were no longer sending logs

### **HR IT Systems Specialist**, October 2017 - February 2020

*Johns Hopkins Hospital*

*Baltimore, MD*

- Provide General HR System Operational Support, which includes all systems supported by the HR IT Department (SuccessFactors, HRAcuity, SAP Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP), and Kronos Timekeeper.
- Managed, created, and maintained configuration files across Linux and Windows environments through the Command Line Interface (CLI) allowing for system stability and optimal performance within the environment.
- Fully understood Agile frameworks and methodologies, having undergone hands-on training sessions that would help in effective adoption by teams for improved project workflows and results.
- Develop expertise in Agile frameworks and methodologies through collaborative training sessions, enabling effective adoption of Agile practices within the team to enhance project outcomes and workflow efficiency.
- Delivered administrative support to HR end-users for recruitment website issues, including management similar to Identity and Access Management (IAM) for account management, and requisition troubleshooting to ensure seamless user functionality
- Updated and audited data for all employees that were collected through Microsoft Access ranging from initial application data to information submitted by career coaches which increased productivity by approximately 50% due to excessive amounts of duplicates, errors, and related data being split into multiple locations.
- Contributed to the documentation of procedures, data structures, and databases, including writing SQL queries used for workforce database management in order to assist with training of HR technology end-users.
- Built reports to send out to HR end users and executives using pivot tables to relay information regarding employee data.
- Automated various Reports to send out to the Talent Acquisition team each week through the use of Query Manager for constant updated recruiting analytical data to be sent out each week.
- Continuously maintained the central employee information database (SAP), allowing for seamless access to accurate and up-to-date employee records.